

1943, November 25

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O. F. M. Cap.

ST. BONAVENTURE MONASTERY
1740 Mt. Elliott
Detroit, Mich
Thanksgiving Day, Nov. 25th 1943.

Mr. Raymon Bowers
4060 Rose Avenue
Western Springs, Illinois.

My Dear Friend:

God bless you and yours. May He guide you for the best in all your ways! Many thanks for your kind favor of October 12th with charitable request. Having read your really pathetic letter, I started at once to write you a reassurance of my heart-felt sympathy and of my prayers for yourself and your three little half-orphants; and now it seems like months instead of weeks that I've been trying to get something back to you worth while; -- sympathy first of course and condolance.

At the same time, however, and the more I think it over, I would be wanting in appreciation of the confidence you manifest in writing me such a letter if, even while condoling with you, I failed, to at least intimate a gentle congratulation. This of course, not on the death of such an ideal wife and mother as was your Kathleen but on your fortune - perhaps wholly unmerrited on your part - of having for years had such a model of Christian perfection to live with and to drinkin for so long the spiritual influences necessarily radiating from the outstanding virtues manifest in the very-day life of any such a Christian. No wonder that you now lament feeling "bankrupt without her".

Your bereavement; yes; inasmuch as viewed through the melancholy lenses of worldly wisdom, so sadly inclined to exclude faith in God and consequently confidence in a favorable hereafter, would be an irreparable loss and misfortune. But O! what a contrast in the light of Christian faith that illuminates the soul of the really practical believer!. "How vain!" exclaims that faith and that philosophy; "How trivial and vain in themselves are the joys and the sorrows alike of this 'momentary existence', that worldlings worship as life!" Truly, We hardly need go further than your own letter and your own recent experience to coroborate with the above; in other words to be convinced that though in themselves are vain, still because of our weaknesses they are unnecessary or helpful-these joys